



Small Hours

TWELVE SHORT POEMS



Kettle

Before the house is quite awake
the kettle clears its throat,
and everything I meant to say
turns into steam and floats.

Lighthouse

All night it says one word
to ships it will not meet:
here, here, here—
as if that were enough to keep.

Inventory

One cup, one chair, one window,
one slow and patient plant.

I count them like a sleepless child
who counts what she still can't.

Snow

The snow came down to listen.
It settled on the street
and held its breath so long that
the town forgot its feet.



Train

A train goes by at two a.m.
with no one, I suppose, aboard—
just lit-up windows, carrying
the dark from town to town, toward.

Library

The books are mostly sleeping.

A few are reading me.

I turn a page, and somewhere
a sentence turns to see.

Small Hours

These are the hours too small for clocks,
the ones you hold, not keep:
the space between a thought and word,
the hallway into sleep.

Letter

I wrote to you and didn't send it.
It waits inside a drawer,
where unsent letters learn the things
that letters are for.



Rain on a Skylight

Someone is typing on the roof
in a language made of glass.
I cannot read a word of it.
I let the paragraphs pass.

Moth

The moth is in love with the lamp
the way I am with June:
foolishly, completely,
and far too soon.

Map

My grandfather drew islands
no bigger than a shoe.
He said the smallest places
are where the sea speaks true.

Morning

And then the light comes, ordinary,
and pours itself like tea.
The night puts down what it was holding.
So, finally, do we.



Read slowly. It's late.